GBDA 302 – Global Digital Project 2
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Side Quest Week 5 - Process & Decision Documentation

1. What I was trying to do

For Week 5, I focused on creating a reflective and meditative camera experience in a side-scrolling world larger than the screen. Rather than emphasizing challenge or speed, the goal was to use slow camera motion, pacing, and exploration to evoke calm and curiosity as the player moves through the environment.

2. One small decision or change I made

A key decision was to slow down the camera movement using low interpolation (lerp) values so the camera gently follows the player instead of snapping to their position. I also added subtle motion to the camera to create a “breathing” effect, reinforcing a calm and reflective tone rather than an action-oriented feel.

When the player completes a level, the camera movement becomes even slower, creating a sense of pause and closure before transitioning to the next level. This was done intentionally to avoid abrupt endings and to maintain a meditative flow.

3. Evidence of the change

To support a reflective and meditative experience, the camera behavior was modified to move more slowly and calmly through the world. The camera now follows the player using a low interpolation (lerp) value and includes subtle motion to avoid rigid or mechanical movement. When all discoverable symbols in a level are collected, the camera slows further before transitioning to the next level, creating a deliberate pause.

Additionally, small interactive symbols were added and distributed across platforms. These symbols are revealed gradually as the camera scrolls through the environment and are collected through exploration rather than direct instruction. Progress is tracked and displayed, and level completion only occurs once all symbols have been discovered.

- Camera logic that adjusts pacing during normal play and after level completion
- Collectible symbols rendered in-world and removed upon discovery
- On-screen progress counter showing collected symbols
- Automatic, calm transition between levels after all symbols are found

4. GenAI Use

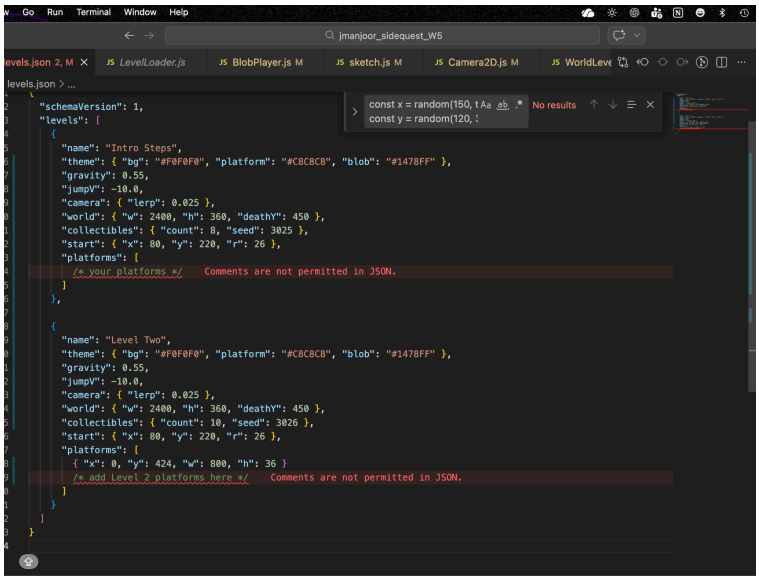
I used GenAI (ChatGPT) to help understand the provided starter code, debug issues related to JSON parsing, camera behavior, and collision logic, and refine the overall class-based structure of the project. GenAI was also used to clarify how to configure levels through JSON and ensure that the camera pacing, discoverable symbols, and level transitions aligned with the Week 5 requirements. All generated suggestions were reviewed, tested, and modified to function correctly within the existing codebase.

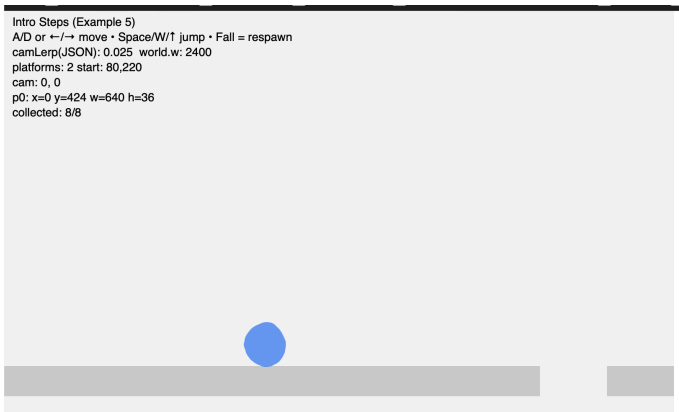
Appendix: GenAI Transcript and Screenshots

Tool Used: ChatGPT

The full GenAI transcripts are extremely long; therefore, direct links are provided below for reference rather than embedding the transcripts in this document.

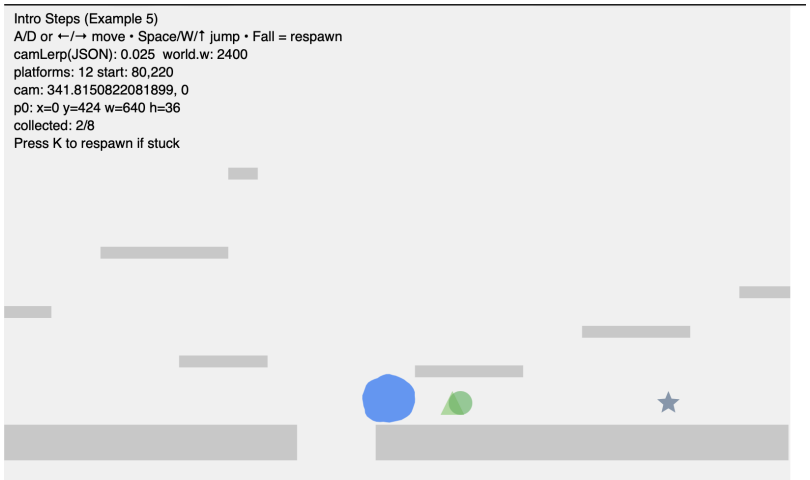
https://chatgpt.com/share/699bb058-83e4-8009-bea9-c8fb6809fa9c
https://chatgpt.com/share/699a4882-56e0-8009-bd16-400a5dd3e6bb



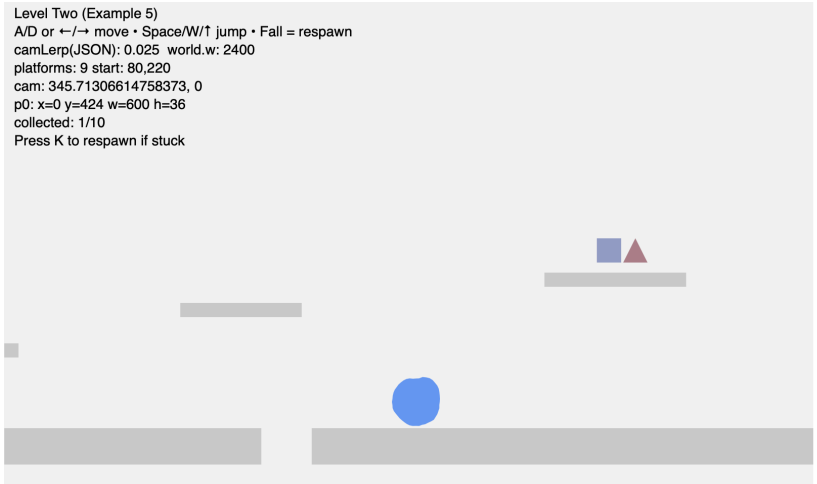


Intro Steps (Example 5)
A/D or ←/→ move • Space/W/↑ jump • Fall = respawn
camLerp(JSON): 0.025 world.w: 2400
platforms: 13 start: 80,220
cam: 285.16441417418986, 0
p0: x=0 y=424 w=640 h=36
collected: 2/8

A/D or ←/→ move • Space/W/↑ jump • Fall = respawn
camLerp(JSON): 0.025 world.w: 2400
platforms: 9 start: 80,220
cam: 1017.2508604120077, 0
p0: x=0 y=424 w=600 h=36
collected: 6/10
Press K to respawn if stuck


Intro Steps (Example 5)
A/D or ←/→ move • Space/W/↑ jump • Fall = respawn
camLerp(JSON): 0.025 world.w: 2400
platforms: 12 start: 80,220
cam: 341.8150822081899, 0
p0: x=0 y=424 w=640 h=36
collected: 2/8
Press K to respawn if stuck

Intro Steps (Example 5)
A/D or ←/→ move • Space/W/↑ jump • Fall = respawn
camLerp(JSON): 0.025 world.w: 2400
platforms: 12 start: 80,220
cam: 1314.7741297114517, 0
p0: x=0 y=424 w=640 h=36
collected: 0/undefined
Press K to respawn if stuck


Level Two (Example 5)
A/D or ←/→ move • Space/W/↑ jump • Fall = respawn
camLerp(JSON): 0.025 world.w: 2400
platforms: 9 start: 80,220
cam: 345.71306614758373, 0
p0: x=0 y=424 w=600 h=36
collected: 1/10
Press K to respawn if stuck